

7.4 The Satellite Revolution

The early 1990's marked a significant change in the Indian media industry. It was the first time since Independence that Indian media became a commercially competitive industry. This was partly due to economic liberalisation, but mostly due to introduction of cable and satellite television in India. It provided a window for billion Indians to see what is happening in the rest of the world. It opened India's social and business eyes in more ways than one. It resulted in the expansion of television not only as an entertainment medium but also as a powerful media tool which further led to many technological changes in ON-AIR broadcasting. It all began with a bang, as for the first time people watched a real war in the Gulf, Live.

This powerful social change is underlined by a constant technological advancement in the Television Industry. The cable channels are constantly providing better feeds to local cable distributors. Initially, channels were broadcasted on an analogue signal, gradually it was replaced by digital channels and now the HDTV is in.

From a mere 410,000 households in January 1992, the number of cable homes had grown to 1.2 million by November 1992. According to the IRS 2002 survey, there are about 38 million operators providing

